



Climate change & mental health

This in-depth report goes over how climate change has begun to affect our mental health, and its implications. <http://digit.in/mar21-53>



Cane furniture

Leading interior designers in India go over why cane furniture is a timeless aesthetic in your living room. <http://digit.in/mar21-54>

and technology. These events are rare, but their impact is extreme. The theory was developed by statistician Nassim Nicholas Taleb in his seminal 2007 book, *The Black Swan*. The novel coronavirus outbreak is an example of a black swan event. In February last year, the Bank for International Settlements released a book called *The Green Swan*, which predicts far worse consequences than Black Swan events, if the challenge of reducing climate change is not addressed. Black Swan events throw a wrench in the risk assessment machinations of major financial institutions, because they just cannot use historical data to account for the new variables introduced. On similar lines, the BIS book predicts that climate change is a variable that historical data cannot account for. Green Swan Events are potential disasters linked to pollution or global warming, that can trigger a worldwide systemic financial collapse.

The problem is that using even cutting edge future looking solutions, assessing risk is no easy task because of the uncertainties involved in climate change, with the fact that many of the green technologies are incipient being a contributing factor. What this means is that climate related risks will remain uninsurable and unhedgeable. For example, a company wanting to offset potential losses in a high risk investment, may not find viable options that are free of risk by climate. The conclusion of the book is that there needs to be a fundamental rethinking of the global socioeconomic system to better allow financial institutions to protect themselves from green swan events.



ECO-ANXIETY

Don't let the pandemic distract you from the real apocalypse taking place on the planet right now. At least some who are realising how dire the situation really is, are suffering from what is called eco-anxiety, which has become a clinical term, with psycholo-

gists studying the impact that climate change has on mental health. It is a feeling of extreme helplessness at the ability of the world of coping with and managing the climate crisis. According to a study conducted in 2018, 70 percent of the people in the US are worried about climate change, and 51 percent express helplessness. The "What is it?" column in *The Hindu* covered eco anxiety in 2019, which painted a even more direct, horrifying and real picture, by asking parents in Delhi how they felt about seeing their children struggling to breathe in the toxic airs of the capital city.



DARK EYE MAKEUP ON TIKTOK

TikTok users are drawing false dark circles underneath their eyes, a bizarre makeup trend that is just another one of those silly two minute storms on the platform. No, it is not an aesthetic derived from working at home and staring at your



laptop screens for too long in a dark environment, instead, it is simply a way to look cute while looking bad. If you don't get it, this is exactly what happens when you get too many pictures of too many people looking too pretty all the time. There is a saturation of this kind of content, so the next best thing is to go back to taking photos similar to the ones amateur boomers snapped on cheap film cam-

eras. There has been a trend on social media and short video platforms of moving away from the overproduced, super slick instagram aesthetic, to imagery that are low quality, blurry, raw and real. Now the trend has swung so far the other way that "influencers" are using makeup to bring out the natural colours of their skin... when the body is fatigued. Maybe it is because the zoomers fresh off the assembly line don't even get dark circles, and feel like they are missing out on something. Fortunately, the whole app is banned in India so we do not have to deal with this nonsense.



CANE FURNITURE

There seems to be a sudden uptick in the preference for cane furniture designs on Instagram, which is not that surprising considering that they are aesthetically pleasing and evoke a sense of nostalgia. This may be the reason why millennials moving into new homes are opting for cane furniture too, because they remind them of furniture in their grandparent's homes, and the carefully posed, lit, touched up and filtered candid gets the most heart reacts on Instagram. The cane furniture itself is age old, with even King Tut being buried next to a cane furniture artefact in 1323 BC, and since then the use of rattan for making furniture has remained timeless and practical. The really pressing question is of course, why is it getting so much attention all of a sudden?

The Architectural Digest has put up a piece on the sudden popularity of cane furniture in January this year, including interviews with local interior designers and brands on exactly why there has been a sudden resurgence in the popularity of cane furniture. Apart from the fact that they are cheap, durable, light and look good, the most important factor may be that cane furniture is environmentally friendly, something that today's consumers are very conscious and concerned about.